

School of Interdisciplinary Studies

American Studies (BA)

The program in American Studies focuses on the study of the cultures, institutions, legal system, political structure, and social processes of the United States. It emphasizes an interdisciplinary perspective. Students choose two broad areas or options to study.

American Studies graduates work in business, culture industries, government, legal fields, media, non-profit organizations, and sports industries. The BA in American Studies is also excellent preparation for law school or graduate school. Each student designs his or her own program within specific guidelines and in consultation with an academic advisor. The courses that a student takes as part of the American Studies program may be given in any school within the University but will include American Studies courses and appropriate Interdisciplinary Studies courses. A list of courses that apply to the American Studies degree may be obtained from the academic advisors in the School of Interdisciplinary Studies. Double majors including American Studies are encouraged.

Bachelor of Arts in American Studies

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Erin A. Smith

Professor of Instruction: Tonja Wissinger

Associate Professors of Instruction: Kathleen Byrnes, Patricia A. Leek

Assistant Professors of Instruction: Kyle Hammonds, Ruth Johnson, Marc Lusk, Michele McNeel, Azadeh Stark, Chelsea Taylor, Larissa Werhnyak

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core

Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[MATH 1306](#) College Algebra for the Non-Scientist¹

[MATH 1314](#) College Algebra¹

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[AMS 2300](#) American Popular Culture

[AMS 2341](#) American Studies for the Twenty-First Century¹

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[GST 2300](#) Introduction to Gender Studies

[PSY 2301](#) Introduction to Psychology

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses.² (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses.²

II. Major Requirements: 49 semester credit hours

[BIS 1100](#) Interdisciplinary Studies First Year Experience

Major Core Courses: 12 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[AMS 3327](#) American Studies: Histories, Theories, Methodologies

[AMS 2341](#) American Studies for the Twenty-First Century^{1, 3}

or [AMS 2300](#) American Popular Culture^{1, 3}

[AMS 3302](#) American Cultures

[BIS 3320](#) The Nature of Intellectual Inquiry

Major Related Courses: Two Options 36 semester credit hours

In addition to the major core courses, students will take 18 semester credit hours of coursework in two of the following subject options, for a total of 36 semester credit hours. Each subject field must be interdisciplinary in nature and must include at least one course providing a historical focus.

American Medicine and Healthcare

American Popular Culture

Communication in 21st Century America

Environment and Community

Law, Legality, and Culture

Race and Ethnicity in American Society

The U. S. and the World

III. Elective Requirements: 29 semester credit hours

Free Electives: 29 semester credit hours

Students must complete a minimum of 45 semester credit hours at UT Dallas. In the final semester, all the coursework should be taken at UT Dallas.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Honors in American Studies

Students must fulfill the requirements for the major and earn at least a 3.900 cumulative GPA as well as a 3.9 GPA in courses used to complete the major. Additionally, students must devote six semester hours to a capstone project approved by the program head. This might consist of an internship, thesis, portfolio project, or upper-level research seminar (or some combination thereof).

Notation on Transcript: Honors in Major

1. A required Major Course that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in the Core Curriculum.
2. Students are strongly encouraged to take core courses that are closely related to their foundations, concentrations, and career goals.
3. If a student has taken one of these options to fulfill core requirements, the other option must be taken to fulfill major requirements.

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